

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-II

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are TWENTY questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-10 carry 10 marks each and should be answered in 150 words.
3. Questions 11-20 carry 15 marks each and should be answered in 250 words.
4. Answers must remain relevant to the demand and use appropriate examples.

Q1. Differentiate the role of B.N. Rau from that of the Drafting Committee in Indian constitution-making.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q2. Explain why corporate social responsibility in India is a statutory obligation rather than philanthropy, and what follows for development outcomes.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q3. Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that can break the cycle.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q4. Why is the Indian Constitution better described as adapted rather than copied?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q5. Explain why a civil-society organisation is a non-State actor even when its advocacy is perceived as adversarial.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q6. Distinguish the two pillars of Ayushman Bharat and explain how they jointly serve universal health coverage.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. The Preamble is part of the Constitution, yet it confers no power and bars none. Examine.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Distinguish digitisation from e-governance and explain why the distinction decides whether a government portal improves an outcome.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q9. Comment on the earn-while-you-learn approach and its contribution to meaningful vocational education and skilling.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q10. "The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy." Elucidate.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q11. Section 6A is constitutionally valid, but its implementation remains a governance challenge. Analyse in light of the 2024 Constitution Bench judgment.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q12. Examine the claim that India's good-governance deficits lie in enforceable conversion mechanisms rather than in the absence of norms.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q13. Assess the claim that India's welfare architecture has moved from discretionary charity to enforceable entitlement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q14. Examine the claim that strategic autonomy is best understood as a method of instrument selection rather than as a fixed alliance preference.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q15. Asymmetrical federalism is an instrument of integration, not a departure from equal citizenship. Examine.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q16. Examine the aims of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 and the separate question of its coverage.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q17. Critically examine the claim that the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005 secures effective access to justice for aggrieved women.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q18. Examine the observation that regional-framework cooperation appeals more to India's smaller neighbours than purely bilateral engagement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q19. Examine whether All-India Services strengthen administrative unity at an excessive cost to State autonomy.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q20. Examine whether digital illiteracy in rural areas, coupled with limited access to information and communication technology, has hindered socio-economic development.

[15 marks | 250 words]

END OF PAPER